

## 9 Great apps to try

The Android Market may not have as many apps as the iPhone App Store yet, but there are still enough to be overwhelmed, and it's growing at a breakneck pace. These indispensable Android apps serve a number of purposes with little overlap. Some are free and some have a price tag, but all of them are at (or near) the top of their category.

### 9.1 Advanced Task Killer

One of the realities of having a multitasking mobile OS in Android is that you have to manage your apps so that they don't hurt performance or battery life. Advanced Task Killer is one of those apps you hope you don't need, but you sometimes must have. It allows you to kill an application with a single click. This particular app killer includes an ignore list, a widget version, and a long-press to menu feature.

### 9.2 ConnectBot

ConnectBot is an open source secure shell client for your Android phone. This client can manage simultaneous ssh connections and copy/paste between apps, and it has shortcuts for <Ctrl> sequences.

### 9.3 Barcode Scanner

This app turns the Android camera into a barcode scanner. You simply scan a product's UPC code and let the app go to work to find it in Google Product Search or a search on the open Web. You'll be amazed at how fast it works. If you need to find product reviews (or price comparisons) while shopping, all you have to do is scan the bar code with your camera and open up the results. No more having to Google a product and sift through pages for reviews and/or prices.

